

96. With reference to the cultural history of India, the term 'Panchayatan' refers to –

- (a) An assembly of village elders
- (b) A religious sect
- (c) A style of temple construction
- (d) An administrative functionary

I.A.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (c)

A temple that has a central shrine surrounded by four subsidiary shrines is called Panchayatana. The origin of the name is the Sanskrit words Pancha (five) and ayatana (containing).

The examples of Panchayatana Temple are

- (i) Kandariya Mahadeo Temple – Khajuraho
- (ii) Brahmeshwar Temple, Lingaraja Temple – Bhubaneswar
- (iii) Dashavatara Temple – Deogarh (U.P.)

97. Naimisharanya, a famous pilgrimage is located in which of the following districts?

- (a) Ujjain
- (b) Mathura
- (c) Sitapur
- (d) Jabalpur

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (c)

Naimisharanya is located in Sitapur, Uttar Pradesh. It is believed that Sage Dadhichi gladly gave up his bones to Devas here. The bones of Sage Dadhichi were used to make the weapon Vajra. This weapon was then used by Lord Indra to defeat the Asuras to reclaim his position as the king of Devloka.

98. With reference to the Indian history of art and culture, consider the following pairs :

Famous work of sculpture	Site
1. A grand image of Buddha's Mahaparinirvana with numerous celestial musicians above and the sorrowful figures of his followers below	: Ajanta
2. A huge image of Varaha Avatar (boar incarnation) of Vishnu, as he rescues Goddess Earth from the deep and chaotic waters, sculpted on rock	: Mount Abu
3. 'Arjuna's Penance'/Descent of Ganga" Sculpted on the surface of huge boulders	: Mamallapuram

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (c)

Among the given pairs, 1 and 3 are correct while 2 is not correct. In the cave number 26 of Ajanta, a grand statue of Mahatma Buddha is engraved. This statue is related to the 'Mahaparinirvana' of Buddha. So statement (1) is correct. The huge statue of Varaha Avatar of Lord Vishnu is described in the Udaygiri caves of Madhya Pradesh, not in Mount Abu Rajasthan. So statement (2) is not correct. 'Arjuna's Penance' sculpted on the surface of huge boulders in Mamallapuram also known as Mahabalipuram is in Chengalpattu district of Tamil Nadu. So statement (3) is also correct. Hence, option (c) is the right answer.

99. Chitrakoot temple is located in which State of India?

- (a) Chhattisgarh
- (b) Orissa
- (c) Madhya Pradesh
- (d) Uttar Pradesh

70th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam 2024

Ans. (*)

Chitrakoot is a famous Hindu pilgrimage site that falls in state of Uttar Pradesh and Madhya Pradesh both, although Chitrakoot district is a part of Uttar Pradesh. Chitrakoot has many famous temples with Kamadgiri as main holy place where Lord Kamata Nath resides. Kamadgiri has some parts in Uttar Pradesh and some in Madhya Pradesh. The question does not clearly mention which temple it is asking about. BPSC has accepted (c) as correct answer.

100. With reference to the art and archaeological history of India, which one among the following was made earliest?

- (a) Lingaraja Temple at Bhubaneswar
- (b) Rock-cut Elephant at Dhauli
- (c) Rock-cut Monuments at Mahabalipuram
- (d) Varaha Image at Udayagiri

I.A.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

Lingaraja Temple at Bhubaneswar was built between 10th-11th century A.D. Rock-cut monuments at Mahabalipuram were built between 7th - 8th century AD. At Udaygiri, Varaha image is a 5th century creation. Rock cut elephant at Dhauli was created during the reign of Ashoka in 3rd century B.C. This is the oldest among the four.

South India (Chola, Chalukya, Pallava and Sangam Period)

*According to the Sangam text, the terms **Kon**, **Ko** and **Mannan** were attributed to the King. Sangam is defined as 'Conference of Poets' or 'Forum of Scholars.' Literature written by scholars during this conference is mentioned as 'Sangam Literature.' *Three Sangams were held under the patronage of Pandya kings in the south.

Sangam	Place	President
First	Madurai	Saint Agastya and Tolkappiyar
Second	Kapadapuram	Saint Agastya
Third	Madurai	Nakkirara

***Agastya** was the sage who is credited with having Aryanised south India. He was born in Kashi, and it is believed that he travelled south from Kashi on request of Gods and later resided in the south. He is also known as “**Father of Tamil Literature.**” **Tolkappiyam** is not only the residual text of 2nd Sangam era but also most ancient available text of Tamil literature. Author **Tolkappiyar** was one among the 12 disciples of **Saint Agastya**. It is a treatise on grammar and poetry. It has been written in formula style. *The author of Tamil Literature **Silappadikaram** was **Ilango Adigal**, grandson of Chola King **Karikal**. The epic narrates the tragic and poignant story of Kannagi and her husband, Kovalan. ***Kural** is considered as the Bible and Laghuveda of Tamil literature. It is also known as ‘**Muppal**’. It was written by the famous poet **Tiruvalluvar**. *Ramavataram, which is Tamil Ramayanam was authored by **Kamban**.

*The history of early Cholas of Sangam literature, the interregnum between fall of Sangam Chola and the rise of Medieval Chola under Vijayalaya (850-871 AD.) in the 9th century. *Chola dynasty was established by **Vijayalaya-I** in Southern India. Parantaka - I defeated Madura King and assumed the title of “**Madurai-Kond.**” ***Rajaraja-I** defeated Cheras naval army in Kandalloor and then **Rajaraja-I** and his son **Rajendra-I** sent an expedition against Sailendra empire of South East Asia and conquered some of the areas as they were facing difficulty in trade with China.

*A special feature of the Chola dynasty was the **autonomy of village administration**. The Chola village administration was very systematic and well-developed. In fact, the autonomous administration was implemented in the village only during the Chola era. *A detailed description of the working system of the executive committee of Gram Sabha (village assembly) in Chola village administration has been archived from **Uttaramerur inscription**, which states that every village had its own committee called '**Sabha**', which was usually independent of Central command and independently administered the village administration. *A working committee that supervised the activities of Chola-era villages was known as **Variyam**. ***Thotta Variyam** looked after **Horticulture Board** while **Samvatsara Variyam** was annual committee; **Eri Variyam** was in charge of **tanks (lakes) and water supply** and **Pon Variyam** was related to **gold/finance committee**.

***Brihadeeswara temple** is an excellent piece of Dravidian style temple of Chola-style, which was constructed in the reign of **Rajaraja-I**. It is considered the biggest and tallest temple in India. *There are two idols of ‘**Dwarpals**’ around the main

shrine. A **gigantic 'Nandi'** (carved out of a single rock) is situated in the exterior of sacrarium which is believed to be the tallest Nandi idol in India.

*Chola Kings maintained massive consolidated troops with a proficient naval power wing. The Chola navy played a vital role in the expansion of the Chola Empire including the conquests of **Ceylon (Sri Lanka)** islands and naval raids on **Srivijaya, Sinhala** and **Maldives**.

*The golden era of Chola empire started with the accession of **Rajaraja- I** to the throne. **Rajaraja- I** was the first Chola king who created Naval Army. ***Rajendra Chola-I** was a Chola emperor, who is considered as one of the greatest rulers and military generals of India. He succeeded his father, **Rajaraja Chola-I**. ***Rajendra-I** conquered the whole of Sri Lanka and brought the king of Sinhaldweep (Sri Lanka) **Mahendra-V** to Chola kingdom as prisoner. He also defeated Pala ruler **Mahipala** and adopted the title of **Gangaikonda**. **Rajendra-I** founded a new capital called **Gangaikonda Cholaपुरam**. The Chola navy was the strongest in the area, and they converted the Bay of Bengal into Chola lake. ***Chola Gangam Ponneri** was an artificial lake constructed by Chola king **Rajendra Chola-I** in memory of his victory over rulers of Ganga river basin, including Bengal Kings and Kalinga Dynasty. ***Vijayabahu**, the Ceylon king, proclaimed independent Sinhala Island during the period of **Kulottunga-I**, but **Kulottunga** did not show any incivility and married his daughter to Sinhala prince **Virapperumal**. *Generally, Chola emperors used to elect their ‘**Yuvraj**’ during their tenure, who becomes the heir of Empire after them.

*Sangam literature only describes the emergence and development of Chola, Chera and Pandya rulers. *During the reign of Chola ruler **Kulottunga-I**, 1077 AD, a Chola Buddhist delegation of 72 merchants was sent to China. *The Chola empire was divided into six provinces for the convenience of administration. *The provinces were called ‘**Mandalam**’. *A province was divided into ‘**Kottam**’ or ‘**Valanadu**’. *It was like the commissionerates. There were many ‘**Nadu**’ in each **Kottam**. *The district was called ‘**Nadu**’. *The assembly of **Nadu** was called ‘**Nattar**’. *The village association was called ‘**Kurram**’. *The smallest unit of administration was **Gram Sabha**. Chola artists were accomplished in carving art.

*They framed numerous portraits of stones and metals. They also prepared bronze sculptures more than stone sculptures. Most elegant idols of **Nataraja (Shiva)** are found in large numbers. They are included in best sculptures of the world. These idols are four-handed. *The **Dakshinamurti idol of Shiva** depicts him as a mentor (Guru, Teacher) . **Shiva** is considered in this form as providing knowledge to his devotees. **Dakshinamurti idol** is installed facing south direction.

*The battle of **Takkolam** was a military engagement between **Rajaditya**, son of the Chola king **Parantaka - I** and a confederacy

of western Gangas, Monas and Vaidunbas led by Rashtrakuta King Krishna - III at Takkolam. The battle fought in 949 AD resulted in the defeat of Cholas and the death of Rajaditya on the battlefield.

*Pallava ruler Singhvishnu (575-600 AD) assumed the titles of 'Avanisingh'. *He defeated the kings of Chola, Pandya, Singhal and Kalmra. *Narasimhavarman I (630 - 668 AD) assumed the title of 'Mahamalla'. *Parmeshwara Varman I (670-700 AD) assumed the title of Lokaditya, Ekamall, Rananjaya, Atyantkam, Ugradand, Gudbhajan, etc. *Mahendravarman-I (600-630 AD) composed a humorous book titled 'Mattvilasaprahasan'.

The list of various ports is available in 'Periplus of the Erythraean Sea', the famous book of an anonymous Greek sailor. **Tondi, Mushiri and Nelisanda** were the main ports of the western coast. At present, the ancient city of Vatapi is in Bagalkot district (Karnataka) is known as Badami. It was the capital of Chalukyas during the 6th - 7th century. Pulakesin - I was the real founder of Vatapi's Chalukya dynasty. Women were appointed to high designations in Chalukya administration. *Vijaya Bhattarika, the Queen of Chandraditya (brother of Vikramaditya - I), issued two copper plates by her name. She was an excellent poetess too. Vijayaditya granted a village to a scholar Brahmin on the recommendation of his younger sister Kumkumdevi. Vijaya Bhattarika ran the administration efficiently. ***Pulakesin - II** was the most capable and powerful ruler of Chalukyas, who ruled from 610 to 642 AD. Aihole inscription provides the saga of his achievements. ***Ma-twa-lin** was a Chinese traveller who has given an account of the relationship between China and India during the reign of Chalukyas.

*Indian black pepper was a favourite ingredient of the most expensive Roman cookery. In Europe, the first spice that was used was pepper, and it gained an enormous social and economic value there. Greeks were familiar with the use of black pepper as early as 4th century BC, though it was probably an uncommon and expensive item. That is why in Sanskrit it is called as '**Yavanapriya**' (the favourite of Greeks). Arikamedu is an archaeological site in southern India at Pondicherry. An intaglio was found here, which was carved with the picture of a man. It was identified as **Augustus Caesar**. Beads and gems were also found. Hence it was concluded that these antiquities belonged to the Roman Empire. Dubreuil called Arikamedu "a true Roman city." In Periplus of the Erythraean Sea, it was called as Poduke. ***Amphora Jar** is an ancient jar with a long and narrow neck and two handles on both sides. This jar was used in ancient Rome as a container for wine or oil. *Various trade unions existed in South Indian townships like **Manigramam, Nanadesi, Valanjiyar**, etc. The purpose of these unions was to encourage trade and business.

***Uraiyur** was a very significant town during Sangam Era, located on the bank of Cauvery River in Tiruchirappalli (Tamil

Nadu). It was known as Koli and Varanam and was the major center of cotton. It is mentioned in "Periplus of the Erythraean Sea." Vengi River was the lifeline of the state of Pandya. The river originates in Kandan Manikanur near Madurai, Tamil Nadu. Pandya state was located to the south of Cauvery. It comprises the districts of modern Madurai and some regions of Travancore also. Its capital was Madura.

***Chera** was a state of South India located in the present-day state of Kerala and to a lesser extent, parts of Tamil Nadu. The capital of the state of Chera was **Vanchi**. *The capital of Kadamba rulers was Vanavasi. Kadamba dynasty was founded by Mayurasharman. The Kadamb state was annexed by Pulakesin - II.

*Pandya king of South India sent an ambassador to the kingdom of Rome in 26 B.C. Pandya dynasty had the longest duration of reign in South Indian region (almost 200 BC to 1378 A.D.). Their capital was Madurai. ***Meenakshi temple** was originally built by Kulasekara Pandya. It is located in Madurai, and the lotus-shaped city surrounds it completely.

1. Who among the following laid the foundation of the Chola Empire in the IXth century A.D.?

- | | |
|----------------|--------------------|
| (a) Krishna-I | (b) Rajaraja Chola |
| (c) Vijayalaya | (d) Parantaka |

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

The history of early Cholas of Sangam literature, the interregnum between the fall of Sangam Chola and the rise of Chola under Vijayalaya (850 AD.) in the 9th century.

2. Who was the founder of the Chola Dynasty?

- | | |
|--|----------------|
| (a) Vijayalaya | (b) Karikala |
| (c) Aditya I | (d) Rajaraja I |
| (e) None of the above/More than one of the above | |

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

3. Which one of the following temple complexes has a massive statue of Nandi, considered to be the biggest in India:

- | |
|------------------------------|
| (a) Brihadeeshwara Temple |
| (b) Lingaraja Temple |
| (c) Kandariya Mahadeo Temple |
| (d) Lepakshi Temple |

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (a)

Brihadeeswara temple is an excellent piece of Dravidian style temple of Chola-style, which was constructed in the reign of Rajaraja-I. It is considered as the biggest and tallest temple of India. There are two idols of 'Dwarpals' around the main shrine. The gigantic 'Nandi' (carved out of single rock) is situated in the exterior of sacrarium which is believed to be the tallest Nandi idol in India.

4. **Brihadeeshwara Temple of Thanjavur was built during the reign of Chola emperor –**

- (a) Parantaka-I (b) Rajaraja-I
(c) Rajendra-I (d) Rajadhiraja-I

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2008

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

5. **In which region was the Chola empire expanded?**

- (a) Vijayanagara Area
(b) Malabar Coast
(c) Hoysala
(d) Coromandel Coast and some region of Deccan

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (d)

The territories of the Chola Dynasty stretched from south to north, namely the banks of Tungabhadra river to Krishna river. The borderlines of Cholas included Coromandel coast and some areas of Deccan like - Uraiyur, Kaveripattinam, Thanjavur, etc.

6. **The capital of Cholas was -**

- (a) Kaveripattinam (b) Mahabalipuram
(c) Kanchi (d) Tanjore

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (d)

According to the given options, the capital of Cholas was Tanjore. Apart from this, later Gangaikondacholapuram also became the capital of Cholas. The capital of Cholas was Uraiyur in Sangam era.

7. **Which of the following was a special feature of Chola administration :**

- (a) Division of empire into mandalam
(b) Autonomy of village administration
(c) Full powers to Ministers of State
(d) Cheap and proper tax collection method

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (b)

A special feature of the Chola dynasty was the autonomy of village administration, which was a speciality of theirs. The Chola village administration was very systematic and well-developed. In fact, the autonomous administration was implemented in the village only during the Chola era.

8. **The Chola age was most famous for :-**

- (a) village assemblies
(b) war with the Rashtrakutas
(c) trade with Ceylon
(d) advancement of Tamil culture
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C (Pre.) 2017

Ans (a)

See the explanation of above question.

9. **The Chola era was famous for:**

- (a) Religious development
(b) Village Assemblies
(c) Warfare with Rashtrakuta
(d) Trade from Sri Lanka

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

10. **Which southern India state had excellent village administration?**

- (a) Chera (b) Chalukya
(c) Chola (d) Vatapi

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

11. **The unique feature of whose administrative system was the development of village autonomy?**

- (a) Cher (b) Chola
(c) Pandyas (d) Pallavas

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

12. **Dynasty famous for efficient rural administration was**

- (a) Cholas (b) Rashtrakutas
(c) Chalukyas (d) Pallavas

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

13. **Which medieval Indian empire was famous for elaborated local self-government?**

- (a) Chalukya (b) Chola
(c) Solanki (d) Parmar
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans (b)

See the explanation of above question.

14. **A lot of details regarding the village administration under the Cholas is provided by the inscription at:-**

- (a) Thanjavur (b) Uraiyur
(c) Kanchipuram (d) Uttaramerur

I.A.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (d)

A detailed description of the working system of the executive committee of Gram Sabha (village assembly) in Chola village administration has been archived from Uttaramerur inscription, which states that every village had its own

committee called 'Sabha' which was usually independent of Central command and independently administered the village administration.

15. During the rule of the Chola Kings which of the following Variyams looked after garden administration?

- (a) Pon Variyam (b) Airi Variyam
(c) Thotta Variyam (d) Samvatsara Variyam

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (c)

A working committee which supervised the activities of Chola era villages was known as Variyam. Thotta Variyam looked after Horticulture Board while Samvatsara Variyam was an annual committee; Eri Variyam was in charge of tanks (lakes) and water supply and Pon Variyam was related to gold/finance committee.

16. Consider the following statements :

- 1. The Cholas defeated Pandya and Chera rulers and established their domination over peninsular India in the early medieval times.**
- 2. The Cholas sent an expedition against Sailendra empire of South East Asia and conquered some of the areas**

Which of these statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

I.A.S. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (c)

Chola dynasty was established by Parantak-I in Southern India. He defeated Madura King and assumed the title of "Madurai-Kond." According to Thanjavur inscription, Rajaraja-I defeated Cheras naval army in Kandalloor and then Rajaraja-I and his son Rajendra-I sent an expedition against Sailendra empire of South East Asia and conquered some of the areas as they were facing difficulty in a trade with China.

17. Bronze icons of Nataraja cast during the Chola period invariably show the deity with :

- (a) Eight hands (b) Six hands
(c) Four hands (d) Two hands

I.A.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (c)

Chola artists (Sthapati) were accomplished in carving art. They framed numerous portraits of stones and metals. Bronze sculptures were prepared vastly than stone sculptures. Most elegant idols of Nataraja (Shiva) are found in large numbers. They are included in the best sculptures of the world. These idols are four the handed.

18. Which one of the following is considered to be the world's greatest iconographical creation made by sthapatis of South India, particularly during the Chola period?

- (a) Mahishasuramardini (b) Nataraja
(c) Rama (d) Somaskanda

I.A.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

19. Most famous sculptures of Chola's age were:

- (a) Stone sculptures
(b) Marble sculptures
(c) Vishnu sculptures
(d) Bronze sculptures of Nataraja Shiva

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

20. The famous bronze image of Nataraja is a fine example of:

- (a) Chola Art (b) Gandhara Art
(c) Gupta Art (d) Mauryan Art

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

21. The 'Dakshinamurti' idol of Shiva depicts him in which form?

- (a) Teacher (b) Dancing
(c) Reclining (d) Meditating

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (a)

The Dakshinamurti idol of Shiva depicts him as a mentor (Guru, Teacher). Shiva is considered in this form as providing knowledge to his devotees. Dakshinamurti idol is installed facing south direction.

22. With reference to the statue of 'Nataraja the Lord of Dance', which of the following statements is/are correct?

- 1. The image represents dancing Shiva having four hands.**
- 2. In his right ear, he wears a man's earring, a woman's in the left.**

**Select the correct answer from the code given below :
Code :**

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2021

Ans. (c)

The Nataraja statue of Lord Shiva represents dancing Shiva with four hands. It combines in a single image Shiva's role as creator, preserver and destroyer of universe. Shiva's dance is set within a flaming halo. The god holds the damru (drum that made the first sound of creation) in his upper right hand. His upper left hand holds agni (the fire that will destroy the universe). With his lower right hand he makes abhaya mudra. Shiva's front left hand, pointing to his raised left foot, signifies refuge for the troubled soul. In his right ear he wears a man's earring, a woman's in the left as a symbol of Ardhanarishwara.

23. In whose tenure 72 traders were sent to China?

- (a) Kulottunga-I (b) Rajendra-I
(c) Rajaraja-I (d) Rajadhiraja-I

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (a)

The Chola sent a goodwill mission of 72 traders to China in the reign of Chola king Kulottunga-I in 1077 A.D.

24. Which of the following South Indian states was famous for its naval power :

- (a) Chola (b) Chera
(c) Pallava (d) Rashtrakuta

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2004

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1993

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (a)

Chola Kings maintained massive consolidated troops with a proficient naval power wing. The Chola navy played a vital role in the expansion of the Chola Empire including the conquests of Ceylon (Sri Lanka) islands and naval raids on Srivijaya, Sinhala and Maldives.

25. Which among the following dynasties, King declared their successor in own tenure?

- (a) Chalukya (b) Chola
(c) Kadamba (d) Kalchuri

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (*)

Generally, Chola emperors used to elect their 'Yuvraj' during their tenure who becomes the heir of Empire after them. But in other empires also, information is available of emperors choosing the crown prince.

26. Who among the following Chola rulers converted the Bay of Bengal into a 'Chola Lake'?

- (a) Rajaraja-I (b) Rajendra-I
(c) Adhiraj (d) Kulottunga

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

Rajendra Chola-I was a Chola emperor, who is considered as one of the greatest rulers and military generals of India. He succeeded his father, Rajaraja Chola-I. Rajendra -I annexed the whole of Sri Lanka and he defeated Mahipal. After that he adopted the title of Gangaikonda. Rajendra-I founded a new capital called Gangaikonda Cholapuram. Chola navy was the strongest in the area, and they converted the Bay of Bengal into Chola lake.

27. Who was the founder of 'Gangai Konda Cholapuram' ?

- (a) Rajaraja-I (b) Rajadhiraj
(c) Rajendra-I (d) Vijayaditya

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

28. Who among the following Chola rulers is credited to have built a huge artificial lake known as Chola Gangam?

- (a) Rajaraja-I (b) Rajendra
(c) Rajdhiraja (d) Rajaraja-II

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

29. Which Chola King started Naval Army?

- (a) Rajendra Chola (b) Parantak Chola
(c) Rajaraja I (d) Rajaraja II
(e) None of these

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (c)

The golden era of the Chola empire started with the accession of Rajaraja- I (985 AD) to the throne. Rajaraja- I was the first Chola king who created the Naval Army.

30. Name the Chola King who conquered the northern part of Sri Lanka?

- (a) Rajaraja-I (b) Rajendra-I
(c) Parantaka-I (d) Aditya-I

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2014

Ans. (a)

Rajaraja-I invaded Sri Lanka and destroyed Anuradhapura. Rajaraja-I captured only the northern part of Sri Lanka while southern part remained independent. His son Rajendra-I captured the southern island and hence whole of Sri Lanka (Ceylon) and defeated Mahendra V.

31. Which one of the Chola kings conquered Ceylon?

- (a) Aditya- I (b) Rajaraja- I
(c) Rajendra- I (d) Vijayalaya

I.A.S. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

32. Who was the Chola monarch who gave complete freedom to Sri Lanka and got his daughter married to the Sinhala Prince?

- (a) Kulottunga I (b) Rajendra
(c) Adhirajendra (d) Rajadhiraj I

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (a)

Vijayabahu, the Ceylon king proclaimed independent Sinhala Island during the period of Kulottunga-I but Kulottunga did not show any incivility and married his daughter with Sinhala prince Virapperumal.

33. Given below are two statements, one is labelled as Assertion (A) and other as Reason (R):

Assertion (A) : We have much more information about Cholas than their predecessors.

Reason (R) : The Chola rulers adopted the practice of having inscriptions written on the walls of temples giving a historical narrative of their victories.

Select the correct answer from the codes given below.
Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
(c) (A) is true but (R) is false
(d) (A) is false but (R) is true

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (a)

We have much more information about Cholas rather than their predecessors. Rajaraja - I & Rajendra - I had written inscriptions on the walls of temples. Rajaraja - I started the tradition of writing & collecting the tales of victories of his ancestors through written inscriptions. Kings after him followed his suit. Hence Assertion (A) & Reason (R) both are correct. So option (a) is correct.

34. In the context of the history of India, consider the following pairs:

Term	Description
Eripatti :	Land, revenue from which was set apart for the maintenance of the village tank
Taniyurs :	Villages donated to a single Brahmin or a group of Brahmins
Ghatikas :	Colleges generally attached to the temples

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 (d) 1 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (d)

The correctly matched list is as follows:

Term	Description
Eripatti :	Land, revenue from which was set apart for the maintenance of village tank
Taniyurs :	A very large village would be administered as a single unit is called Taniyurs.
Ghatikas :	Colleges generally attached to the temples.

Thus, in the given options, (1) and (3) are correctly matched.

35. Which of the following institutions belonged to foreign trade?

- (a) Sreni (b) Nagaram
(c) Nanadesis (d) Manigrama

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (c & d)

Sreni, in the context of Ancient India, was an association of traders, merchants and artisans. Nagaram was a local association of merchants conducting commercial activities. The Nanadesis and Manigrama were guilds of traders who organised themselves into one of the biggest trading associations at the time of the Hoysala empire. They developed significant trade contact with many areas, including foreign countries.

36. Which one of the following trade centres of ancient India was on the trade route connecting Kalyana with Vengi?

- (a) Tagara (b) Sripur
(c) Tripuri (d) Tamralipti

I.A.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

Tagara was a significant trade centre that was located between Kalyan and Vengi.

37. Who was the greatest king of Chalukya dynasty?

- (a) Vikramaditya (b) Manglesh
(c) Pulakesin - II (d) Pulakesin - I

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (c)

Pulakesin - II was the most capable and powerful ruler of Chalukyas, who ruled from 610 to 642 AD. Aihole inscription provides the saga of his achievements.

38. Which of the following dynasties frequently assigned to the ladies high ranking positions in administration?

- (a) Chola (b) Chalukya
(c) Pala (d) Sena

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (b)

Women were appointed to high designations in Chalukya administration. Vijaya Bhattacharika, the Queen of Chandraditya (brother of Vikramaditya - I), issued two copper plates in her name. She was an excellent poetess too. Vikramaditya granted a village to a scholar Brahmin on the recommendation of his younger sister Kumkumdevi. Vijaya Bhattacharika ran the administration efficiently.

39. Where was the capital of Chalukyas located?

- (a) Vatapi (b) Shravasti
(c) Kanchi (d) Kannauj

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (a)

At present, the ancient city of Vatapi in Bagalkot district (Karnataka) is known as Badami. It was the capital of Chalukyas during the 6-7th century. Pulakesin - I was the real founder of Vatapi's Chalukya dynasty.

40. The name of poet Kalidasa is mentioned in the:

- (a) Allahabad Pillar Inscription
(b) Aihole Inscription
(c) Alapadu Grant
(d) Hanumankonda Inscription

I.A.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

Aihole inscription is an authentic source for Pulakesin - II history. It is engraved in Sanskrit and southern Brahmi language and was written by Ravikirti. At the end of commendation, the author claimed that he had gained fame like Kalidasa and Bharavi by writing this. Thus, the name of poet Kalidasa is mentioned in the Aihole inscription.

41. The Sanskrit poet and dramatist Kalidasa finds a mention in –

- (a) Aihole inscription of Pulakesin-II
(b) Gwalior inscription of Mihir Bhoja
(c) Karamdanda Sivalinga inscription of Kumargupta-I
(d) Mathura Pillar inscription of Chandragupta-II

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

42. Which of the following King, did send two naval expeditions to Ceylon in 642 AD?

- (a) Rajaraj (b) Narasimha Verman I
(c) Kirti Verman I (d) Jayasinha I

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2016

Ans (b)

Narasimha Varman I was a king of the Pallava dynasty who ruled South India from 630-668 AD. He was also known as Mahamalla (great wrestler), and during his reign famous Panch Ratha Temples were constructed. He captured & destroyed capital of Chalukya (Vatapi) and assumed the title of Vatapi-konda. In 642 AD, he sent two naval expeditions to Ceylon (Sri Lanka) to help a Sri Lankan prince.

43. The term 'Yavanapriya' mentioned in ancient Sanskrit text denoted :

- (a) A fine variety of Indian muslin
(b) Ivory

- (c) Damsels sent to the Greek court for dance performance
(d) Pepper

I.A.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (d)

Indian black pepper was a favourite ingredient of the most expensive Roman cookery. That is why in Sanskrit, it is called as 'Yavanapriya' (the favourite of Greeks).

44. Halbi is related to which language family?

- (a) Aryan (b) Dravidian
(c) Mundari (d) None of these

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (a)

Halbi is an eastern Indo-Aryan language, of Bastar, Chhattisgarh transitional between Oriya and Marathi. Halbi is written in the Oriya and Devanagari script.

45. Tolkappiyam text deals with :

- (a) Administration (b) Law
(c) Grammar and Poetry (d) All the above

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

Tolkappiyam is not only the residual text of 2nd Sangam era but also the most ancient available text of Tamil literature. Author Tolkappiyar was one among the 12 disciples of saint Agastya. It is a treatise on grammar and poetry. It has been written in formula style.

46. The Sangam text Tolkappiyam is a work on

- (a) Astronomy (b) Grammar
(c) Music (d) Medicine

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (b)

Tolkappiyam is the most ancient extant Tamil grammar text and the oldest extant long work of Tamil literature. Tolkappiyam is a unique work on grammar and poetics, in its three parts of nine sections, each dealing with Ezhuttu (letter), Col (word) and Porul (subject matter).

47. In Sangam Literature 'Tolkappiyam' is a text of –

- (a) Tamil poetry (b) Tamil grammar
(c) Tamil architecture (d) Tamil polity

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2014

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

48. The author of the Silapadikaram was –

- (a) Ilango (b) Parmara
(c) Karikala (d) Vishnu Swami

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2002

Ans. (a)

The author of Tamil Literature Silappadikaram was Ilango Adigal, grandson of Chola King Karikal. The epic narrates the tragic and poignant story of Kannagi and her husband, Kovalan.

49. Match items of List-I with those of List-II and select your correct answer from the codes given below in the lists :

List-I	List-II
A. Thirukural	1. Love Story
B. Tolkappiyam	2. Philosophy
C. Silappadikaram	3. Merchant Story
D. Manimekalai	4. Grammar

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	2	4	3
(b)	2	3	4	1
(c)	4	2	3	1
(d)	2	4	1	3

U.P.P.S.C. (R.I.) 2014

Ans. (d)

The correctly matched pairs are :

List I		List II
Thirukural	–	Philosophy
Tolkappiyam	–	Grammar
Silappadikaram	–	Love Story
Manimekalai	–	Merchant story

50. The collection of the writings of the Saivite saints is considered as Fifth Veda. What is the name of the above collection?

- (a) Tolkapiyam (b) Silappadikaram
(c) Manimekhalai (d) Tirumurai

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre.) 2021

Ans. (d)

Tirumurai is a twelve-volume compendium of songs or hymns in praise of Shiva in the Tamil language from the 6th to 11th century CE. It is compilation of writings of various poets. Tirumurai along with Vedas and Saiva agamas forms the basis of Saiva Siddhantha philosophy in South India.

51. How many Alvars and Nayanars are there according to tradition?

- (a) 12 and 63 (b) 12 and 53
(c) 23 and 63 (d) 23 and 53

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (a)

The Alvars and Nayanars are two groups of saint-poets in Bhakti tradition of South India, particularly in the Tamil-speaking regions. The Alvars are devoted to Lord Vishnu. There are 12 prominent Alvars in the tradition. The Nayanars on the other hand are devoted to Lord Shiva. There are 63 Nayanars who are widely celebrated in the tradition.

52. Which one of the following statements about Sangam literature in ancient South India is correct?

- (a) Sangam poems are devoid of any reference to material culture.
(b) The social classification of Varna was known to Sangam poets.
(c) Sangam poems have no reference to warrior ethic.
(d) Sangam literature refers to magical forces as irrational.

I.A.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

Sangam literature is one of the oldest available Tamil literatures. The poetry composed during Sangam period depicts societal, economic, religious conditions etc. of contemporary South India. These poems also depict material culture of that period. The social classification of Varna was known to Sangam poets. Sangam poems describe warrior ethic as well as magical forces in nature.

53. From the excavations of which ancient site, information has been gathered regarding brisk trade relations between India and Rome, during the early centuries of Christian era :

- (a) Madurai (b) Tamralipti
(c) Tondi (d) Arikamedu

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2003

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2002

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (d)

Arikamedu is an archaeological site in South-eastern coast of India at Pondicherry. An intaglio was found here which was carved with the picture of a man. It was identified as Augustus Caesar. Beads and gems were also found. Hence it was concluded that these antiquities belonged to the Roman Empire. Dubreuil called Arikamedu "a true Roman city." In Periplus of the Erythraean Sea, it was called as Poduke.

54. The foremost Indo-Roman trading station in Eastern India was :

- (a) Tamluk (b) Rajgir
(c) Arikamedu (d) Bhagrapir

[Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre)-2021]

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

55. Which one of the following ports was known as Poduke to the author of 'The Periplus of the Erythraean Sea' :

- (a) Arikamedu (b) Tamralipti
(c) Korkai (d) Barbaricum

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

56. The Roman settlement has been found?

- (a) Kalibangan (b) Arikamedu
(c) Rangpur (d) Satara

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

57. Amphora Jar is a –

- (a) Perforated jar (b) Tall double handle jar
(c) Painted grey jar (d) Black and red ware jar

U.P.P.S.C. (R.I.) 2014

Ans. (b)

Amphora Jar is an ancient jar with a long and narrow neck and two handles on both sides. This jar was used in ancient Rome as a container for wine or oil.

58. Which of the following dynasties is not mentioned in Sangam literature?

- (a) Kadamb (b) Chera
(c) Chola (d) Pandya

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)

The origin and elevation of Chola, Cheras and Pandyas are mentioned in Sangam Literature. Kadamb or any other dynasty is not mentioned in Sangam literature.

59. Which one of the following was not a ruling dynasty of the Tamil country during the Sangam Age?

- (a) Chera (b) Chola
(c) Pallava (d) Pandya

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Mains) 2010

Ans. (c)

In South India, three dynasties ruled during the Sangam Age are Chera, Chola and the Pandya. Pallavas were not the rulers of this age.

60. Religious anthology 'Kural' composed in which language?

- (a) Greek (b) Tamil
(c) Telugu (d) Pali

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (b)

Kural is considered as the Bible and Laghuveda of Tamil literature. It is also known as 'Muppal'. It was written by the famous poet Tiruvalluvar. According to hearsay, Thiruvalluvar was the advent of Brahma.

61. Which one of the following Tamil Texts has been called Laghuveda?

- (a) Nandikalambakam (b) Kalingattuparani
(c) Periyapuranam (d) Kural

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (d)

Tamil text 'Kural' is considered as Laghuveda and was authored by Thiruvalluvar.

62. Which one of the following explains the practice of 'Vattakirutal' as mentioned in Sangam poems?

- (a) Kings employing women bodyguards
(b) Learned persons assembling in royal courts to discuss religious and philosophical matters
(c) Young girls keeping watch over agricultural fields and driving away birds and animals
(d) A king defeated in a battle committing ritual suicide by starving himself to death

I.A.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (d)

'Vattakirutal' ritual was a Tamil ritual of fasting unto death. This practice was mainly prevalent during the Sangam period. This was a way of ritual suicide by a king defeated in a battle by starving himself to death.

63. Who among the following was the author of the Tamil Ramayanam or Ramavataram ?

- (a) Kamban (b) Kuttan
(c) Nannaya (d) Tikkana

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Mains) 2010

Ans. (a)

Ramavataram or Tamil Ramayanam was authored by Kamban.

64. With reference to the cultural history of medieval India, consider the following statements:

1. Siddhas (Sittars) of Tamil region were monotheistic and condemned idolatry.
2. Lingayats of Kannada region questioned the theory of rebirth and rejected the caste hierarchy.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

I.A.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

Siddhas are traced back to Sangama period, but the word Siddha is not found in Sangama literature. It is closely linked with origin and development of Shaivism, Siddhanta philosophy, Tantras Science and Technology in South India. Siddhas means refined monotheistic and condemned idolatry. Thus, statement (1) is correct. Lingayats of Kannada region challenged the idea of caste attributed by certain groups of Brahmins. They also questioned the theory of rebirth. They encouraged remarriage of widows and disapproved of pre-puberty marriage. Thus, statement (2) is also correct.

65. Match List I with List II and select the correct answer using codes given below the lists :

List-I	List-II
A. Gupta	1. Badami
B. Chandela	2. Panamalai
C. Chalukya	3. Khajuraho
D. Pallava	4. Deogarh

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	4	3	1	2
(b)	4	2	3	1
(c)	2	3	4	1
(d)	3	4	1	2

I.A.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (a)

Dashavatara Temple is located in Deogarh in the Lalitpur district, Uttar Pradesh. It belongs to the Gupta era. Khajuraho proclaims rich art culture of Chandelas. There are approximately 25 temples that are related to Vishnu, Shiva and Jain deities. The most famous temple is Kandariya Mahadeva. Chalukyas had their capital at Badami (Karnataka) and Panamalai is related to Pallava.

66. Which one of the following was a corporation of merchants in ancient India?

- (a) Chaturvedimangalam (b) Parishad
(c) Ashtadiggaja (d) Manigramam

I.A.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (d)

Various trade unions existed in South Indian townships like Manigramam, Nanadesi, Valanjiyar, etc. The purpose of these unions was to encourage trade and business.

67. Famous South Indian 'The Battle of Takkolam' was fought between?

- (a) Between Chola and North Chalukyas
(b) Between Chola and Rashtrakutas
(c) Between Chola and Hoyasala
(d) Between Chola and Pandya

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (b)

The battle of Takkolam was a military engagement between Rajaditya, son of the Chola king Parantaka - I and a confederacy of western Gangas and Vaidunbas led by Rashtrakuta King Krishna - III at Takkolam.

68. Who devastated Chola dynasty eventually?

- (a) Mahmud Ghaznavi (b) Bakhtiyar Khalji
(c) Muhammad Gauri (d) Malik Kafur

U. P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (*)

Near about 1250 AD Hoyasala and Pandya Kingdom defeated Chola King Rajendra III. Chola dynasty ended nearly 1279 AD. Malik Kafur conquered South India in nearly 1310 AD. He conquered Yadav, Hoyasala, Kakatiya and Pandya.

69. Why was 'Uraiyur' famous in Sangam Era?

- (a) An important trade centre of spices
(b) An important trade centre of cotton
(c) An important centre of foreign trade
(d) An important centre of domestic trade

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

Uraiyur was a very significant town during Sangam Era, located on the bank of Cauvery river in Tiruchirappalli (Tamil Nadu). It was known as Koli and Varanam and was the major centre of cotton. It is mentioned in "Periplus of the Erythraean Sea."

70. Udiyanjir belongs to which dynasty?

- (a) Chera dynasty (b) Pandya dynasty
(c) Chola dynasty (d) Satavahana dynasty

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (a)

Udiyanjir belongs to Chera dynasty. Chera empire was in modern Kerala. He was first historical king of Sangama period. As per legends, he provided a feast to all the fighters of Mahabharata war.

71. Which river was the lifeline of Pandya state?

- (a) Godavari (b) Krishna
(c) Tungabhadra (d) Vengi

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2010

Ans. (d)

Vengi River was the lifeline of the state of Pandya. The river originates in Kandan Manikanur near Madurai, Tamil Nadu. Pandya state was located in the south of Kaveri. It comprises the districts of modern Madurai and Tirunelveli district (Tamil Nadu) and some regions of Kerala also. Its capital was Madura. The region of Vengi river was famous for its fertility.

72. Which of the following Sangam ports were situated on the western coast? Select the correct answer from the code given below:

1. Korkai 2. Puhar
3. Tondi 4. Mushiri

Code :

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 3 and 4 only (d) 4 and 1 only

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (c)

The list of various ports is available in 'Periplus of the Erythraean Sea', the famous book of an anonymous Greek sailor. Naura, Tondi, Mushiri and Nelisanda were the main ports of the western coast.

73. With reference to ancient South India, Korkai, Poompuhar and Muchiri were well known as

- (a) capital cities
- (b) ports
- (c) centres of iron and steel making
- (d) shrines of Jain Tirthankaras

I.A.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (b)

Poompuhar is a major city in the South Indian state of Tamil Nadu. It was a prosperous port city in ancient times, known as Kaveri Poompattinam and Kaveripattinam. It served as the capital of the early Chola kings. Korkai was a port city of the Pandyas, located near the Bay of Bengal. Evidence of developed trade with ancient Roman civilisation has been found from here. Muziris/Muchiri was a port city in Kerala. It was one of the oldest ports in the world. Sangam literature mentions this port.

74. According to the Sangam texts the terms Kon, Ko and Mannan were attributed to which of the following?

- (a) Prime Minister
- (b) Revenue Minister
- (c) Commander of the army
- (d) King

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2010

Ans. (d)

According to the Sangam text, the terms Kon, Ko and Mannan, were attributed to the King.

75. Third Sangam was held at :

- (a) Arikamedu
- (b) Ernakulam
- (c) Madurai
- (d) Tuticorin

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (c)

Sangam is defined as 'Conference of Poets' or 'Forum of Scholars.' Literature written by scholars during this conference is mentioned as 'Sangam Literature.' Three Sangams were held under the patronage of Pandya kings in the south.

Sangam	Place	President
1st	Madurai	Saint Agastya
2nd	Kapadapuram	Saint Agastya
3rd	Madurai	Nakkirar

76. The sage who is said to have Aryanised South India was

- (a) Vishwamitra
- (b) Agastya
- (c) Vashishtha
- (d) Sambhara

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (b)

Agastya is the sage who is credited with having Aryanised South India. It is believed that he travelled south on request of Gods and later resided there. He is also known as "Father of Tamil Literature."

77. Match List- I with List -II and select correct answer with the help of codes given below:

List -I

- A. Chalukyas
- B. Pallava
- C. Harsha
- D. Pandya

List-II

- 1. Madurai
- 2. Kannauj
- 3. Badami
- 4. Kanchipuram

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	3	4	2	1
(b)	4	3	2	1
(c)	1	4	2	3
(d)	1	3	2	4

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2004

Ans. (a)

Badami was the capital of Chalukyas. Pulakesin-II was the most glorious king of Badami Chalukyas. The detailed history of Pulakesin-II is known from the Aihole inscription written by Ravikirti. The capital of Pallavas was Kanchipuram. Harsha, along with his sister Rajyashri, ruled jointly over Kannauj. Madurai was the capital of Pandyas.

78. Consider the following events in the history of India :

1. Rise of Pratiharas under King Bhoja
2. Establishment of Pallava power under Mahendravarman-I
3. Establishment of Chola power by Parantaka - I
4. Pala dynasty founded by Gopala

What is the correct chronological order of the above events, starting from the earliest time?

- (a) 2 - 1 - 4 - 3
- (b) 3 - 1 - 4 - 2
- (c) 2 - 4 - 1 - 3
- (d) 3 - 4 - 1 - 2

I.A.S. (Pre) 2020

Ans (c)

Following is the sequence of events :-
Mahendravarman- I established Pallava Power (600-630 A.D.);
Gopala founded Pala dynasty in 750 A.D.;
Mihirabhoja (836-885 A.D.) or Bhoja I was a ruler of Gurjara Pratihara dynasty of India;
Parantaka - I (907-953 A.D.) ruled Chola kingdom in South India.

79. Which of the following pair (A State of South India from 6th to 12th century and its Capital) is not correctly matched?

- (a) Pallava-Kanchipuram
- (b) Pandya-Madurai
- (c) Chera-Puducheri
- (d) Chola-Tanjvur
- (e) Hoyasala-Dwarasamudra

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

Chera was a state of South India located in the present-day state of Kerala and to a lesser extent, parts of Tamil Nadu. The capital of the state of Chera was Vanchi. All other options are correctly matched.

80. Which of the following was the capital of Chera dynasty ?

- (a) Karuvur/Karur
- (b) Kanchipuram
- (c) Madurai
- (d) More than one of the above

70th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (a)

The Chera dynasty ruled over the southwestern part of South India (present-day Kerala and parts of Tamil Nadu). Karur/Karuvur was their capital. According to some sources, their capital is also mentioned as Thondi. Its other name was Vanchi.

81. Arrange the names of the following Pallava rulers according to their reign in correct chronological order and select the correct answer from the codes given below :

1. Parmeshvaravarman I
2. Narsinghvarman I
3. Nandivarman II
4. Mahendravarman I

Codes :

- (a) 4, 2, 1, 3
- (b) 4, 3, 1, 2
- (c) 1, 3, 2, 4
- (d) 3, 2, 1, 4

U.P.B.E.O. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

As per the question, timeline of Pallava king's rule is as follows :-

1. Mahendravarman I - (600-630 A.D.)
2. Narsinghvarman I - (630-668 A.D.)
3. Parmeshwaravarman I - (Approx 670-700 A.D.)
4. Nandivarman II - (731-795 A.D.)

Hence option (a) is right answer.

82. Who of the following Chinese travellers has given an account of the relationship of China with India during the reign of Chalukyas?

- (a) Fa-Hien
- (b) Hiuen-Tsang
- (c) It-Sing
- (d) Matwalin

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2014

Ans. (d)

Matwalin was a Chinese traveller who gave an account of the relationship between China and India during the reign of Chalukyas.

83. Which dynasty did not rule over North India?

- (a) Chalukyas
- (b) Rajputs
- (c) Gupta
- (d) Mauryas

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (a)

Chalukya Dynasty did not rule over North India. Their rule was mainly centralized in Deccan and Southern India. Their capital was Badami (Vatapi). Pulakesin - II was the first ruler of Badami's Chalukya dynasty who defeated Harshavardhana in 618 AD. Apart from this, there were also small branches of Chalukyas in which the Chalukyas of Kalyani were most prominent.

84. Which of the following King is known to have sent his ministers to suppress the cruelty against animals in Kashi region?

- (a) Chalukya King Siddharaja Jayasimha
- (b) Chalukya King Kumarapala
- (c) Chola King Kulottunga I
- (d) Kashmirian King Jayasimha

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (b)

Kumarapala was a Chalukya king. He reigned for 29 years. He was a Jain and a disciple of Jain Scholar Hemachandra. Several medieval Jain scholars wrote chronicles about him. As per Jain traditions he was against animal cruelty and sent his minister to suppress the cruelty against animals in Kashi region.

85. The capital of Kadamba Kings was –

- (a) Tanjore
- (b) Vanavasi
- (c) Kanchi
- (d) Badami

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Ans. (b)

The capital of Kadamba rulers was Vanavasi. Kadamba dynasty was founded by Mayurasharman. Kadamba state was annexed by Pulakesin - II. It is notable that Tanjore was the capital of Cholas; Kanchi of Pallavas and Badami of Chalukyas.

86. Which one of the following was a very important seaport in the Kakatiya kingdom?

- (a) Kakinada
- (b) Motupalli
- (c) Machilipatnam (Masulipatnam)
- (d) Nelluru

[I.A.S. (Pre)-2017]

Ans. (b)

Motupalli was the famous trading seaport of the Kakatiyas. Marco Polo visited Kakatiya kingdom through this port and wrote about the prosperity and power in Andhra Desh in his travelogue.

87. A king of South India sent an ambassador to the kingdom of Rome in 26 B.C. to which dynasty did he belong?

- (a) Chola
- (b) Chera
- (c) Pandya
- (d) Chalukya

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2005